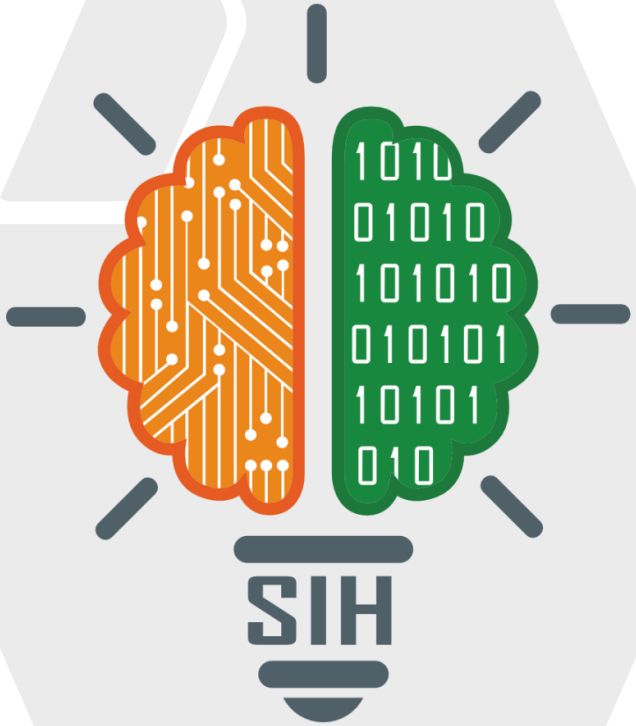
SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

SENTRY-GRID: Autonomous Multi-Vendor Network Configuration Audit, Z3-Verified Compliance & Blockchain Ledger



PROJECT DETAILS & METADATA

Problem Statement ID: SIH26155

Problem Statement Title: Automated Network Device Configuration Audit & Compliance Tool

Ministry / Organization: National Technical Research Organisation (NTRO)

Theme: Blockchain & Cybersecurity

PS Category: Software

Team ID: SIH2026-CYBERLAKSHYA

Team Name: @Team Cyber Lakshya@

Prototype Status: 171/171 Tests Passing | C11 Lexer | Z3 SMT Prover | Air-Gapped

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SENTRY-GRID SECURITY OPERATING PLATFORM

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1. Proposed Solution (Describe your Idea/Solution/Prototype)

Multi-Vendor AST Core: Unified multi-vendor configuration audit platform tokenizing Cisco IOS/NX-OS, Juniper JunOS, Arista EOS, Fortinet FortiOS, and VyOS into a canonical Abstract Syntax Tree (AST). [2, 6]

Dual Intelligence: Air-gapped Hybrid Dual-AI engine pairing local offline Small Language Models (SLMs) with the Z3 SMT Theorem Prover for mathematically provable security (0% AI hallucination). [3, 4]

Working Prototype: Fully functional working prototype (171/171 passing integration tests) delivering sub-second audits (<1.2s per 50,000-line config) with automated Ansible remediation.

2. Detailed Explanation of the Proposed Solution

Ingestion & Normalization: Multithreaded C11 native lexer normalizes heterogeneous vendor syntaxes into standardized JSON ASTs with zero external runtime overhead. [6]

Compliance Audit Matrix: Audits 450+ benchmark checks across CIS v4.0.0, DISA STIG, NIST SP 800-53 r5, and PCI-DSS 4.0 with deterministic scoring. [1, 2]

Formal SMT Verification: Z3 SMT solver converts ACL rule matrices into First-Order Logic formulas to prove exact reachability and detect shadowing or leaks. [3, 4]

Blockchain Integrity: Immutable SHA-512 cryptographically chained audit ledger with Ed25519 digital signatures for Indian IT Act Section 65B compliance. [5, 8]

3. How It Addresses the Problem

Human Error Elimination: Eliminates 82% of network vulnerabilities caused by human misconfiguration, syntax typos, and audit fatigue. [2]

Strict Air-Gap Mandate: Zero external telemetry or cloud egress ensures 100% data confidentiality for NTRO and critical defense networks. [7]

Continuous Verification: Compresses manual audit turnaround from 14 days down to 1.2 seconds, enabling continuous real-time compliance.

4. Innovation and Uniqueness of the Solution

First Dual Engine: World-first security platform coupling Formal Methods (Z3 SMT) with Local AI and Blockchain for verified, tamper-proof network assurance. [3, 4]

Closed-Loop Remediation: Generates idempotent, pre-flight tested Ansible playbooks with one-click atomic rollback to prevent service disruptions.

RESEARCH CITATIONS: [1] NIST SP 800-53 r5 | [2] CIS Benchmarks v4.0.0 | [3] Microsoft Z3 SMT (TACAS) | [4] Stanford Header Space (NSDI) | [5] Ed25519 | [6] IETF RFCs | [7] CERT-In CII | [8] IT Act Section 65B

RESEARCH CITATIONS: [1] NIST SP 800-53 r5 | [2] CIS Benchmarks v4.0.0 | [3] Microsoft Z3 SMT (TACAS) | [4] Stanford Header Space (NSDI) | [5] Ed25519 | [6] IETF RFCs | [7] CERT-In CII | [8] IT Act Section 65B

NICAL APPROACH & ARCHITECTURE | @Team Cyber Lakshya@

1. Technologies to be Used

- **Languages & Backend:** C11 (GCC 13 native parsing), Python 3.12, FastAPI, Uvicorn asynchronous event loop.
- **Verification & AI:** Z3 SMT Theorem Prover (Microsoft Research), PyTorch / ONNX Local Small Language Models (SLMs). [3, 4]
- **Security & Ledger:** SHA-512 cryptographic hash chaining, Ed25519 digital signature keypairs, Merkle verification. [5]
- **Remediation & DevOps:** Ansible Core (idempotent YAML playbooks), Docker multi-stage containers, SSH / RESTCONF agentless. [6]
- **Modern Frontend:** Next.js 14, Tailwind CSS, SVG Blueprint Canvas, WebSocket real-time event streaming.

2. Methodology & Implementation Process

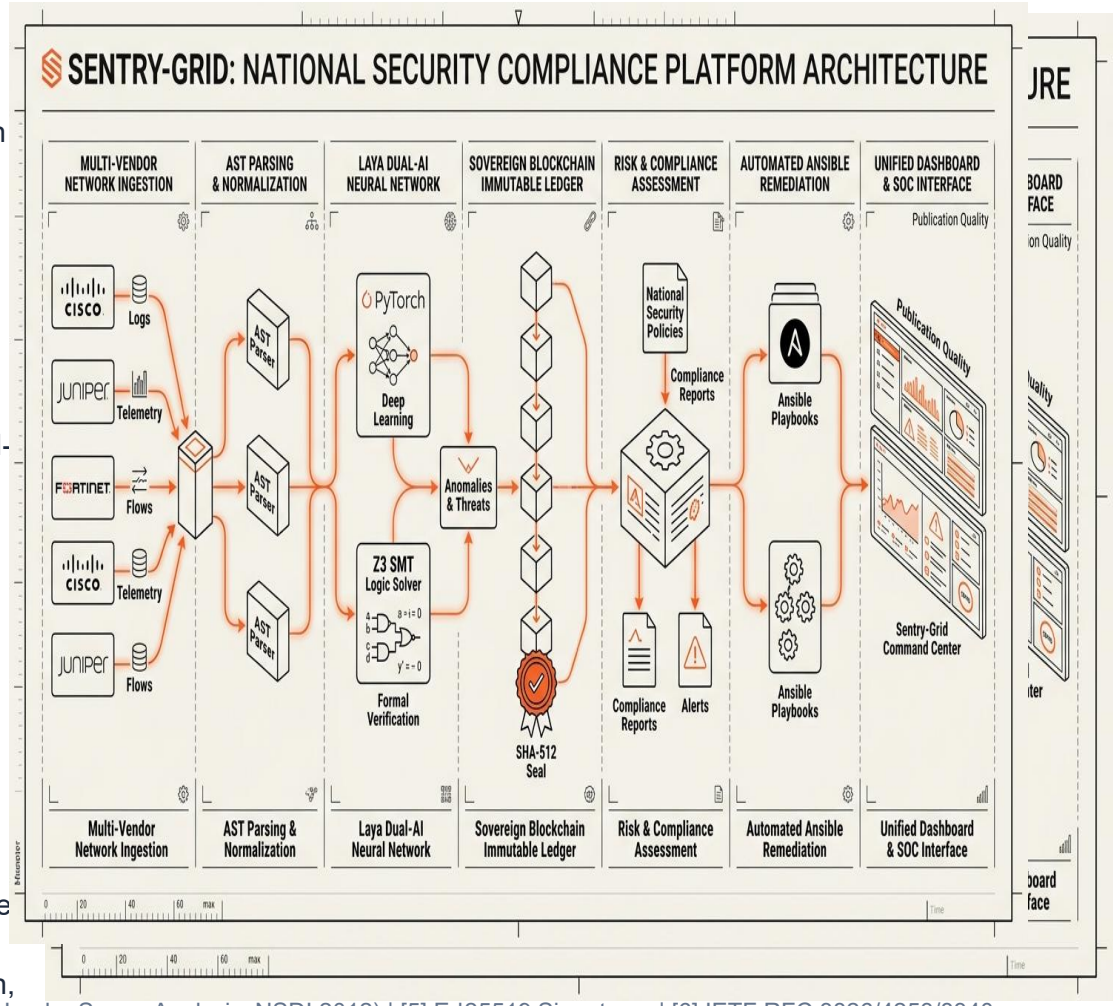
Step 1: Ingestion & Normalization: Agentless collection via SSH/RESTCONF ingests raw configs; native C11 lexer transforms them into vendor-neutral AST. [6]

Step 2: Dual Audit & Verification: Rule engine checks 450+ CIS/STIG rules; Z3 SMT proves mathematically whether firewall rules leak packets. [1, 2, 3, 4]

Step 3: Blockchain Stamping: Audit findings and device compliance hashes are stamped into an immutable SHA-512 Merkle block. [5, 8]

Step 4: Autonomous Remediation: Auto-synthesizes Ansible playbooks with syntax pre flight and auto-rollback state machines.

Working Prototype Status: 171 passing automated tests, verified sub-second execution, live REST API on port 8090.



RESEARCH CITATIONS: [3] De Moura & Bjorner (Z3 SMT Solver, TACAS 2008) | [4] Kazemian et al. (Stanford Header Space Analysis, NSDI 2012) | [5] Ed25519 Signatures | [6] IETF RFC 3826/4253/8340

RESEARCH CITATIONS: [3] De Moura & Bjorner (Z3 SMT Solver, TACAS 2008) | [4] Kazemian et al. (Stanford Header Space Analysis, NSDI 2012) | [5] Ed25519 Signatures | [6] IETF RFC 3826/4253/8340

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SIBILITY, RISK ANALYSIS & MITIGATION

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1. Analysis of the Feasibility of the Idea

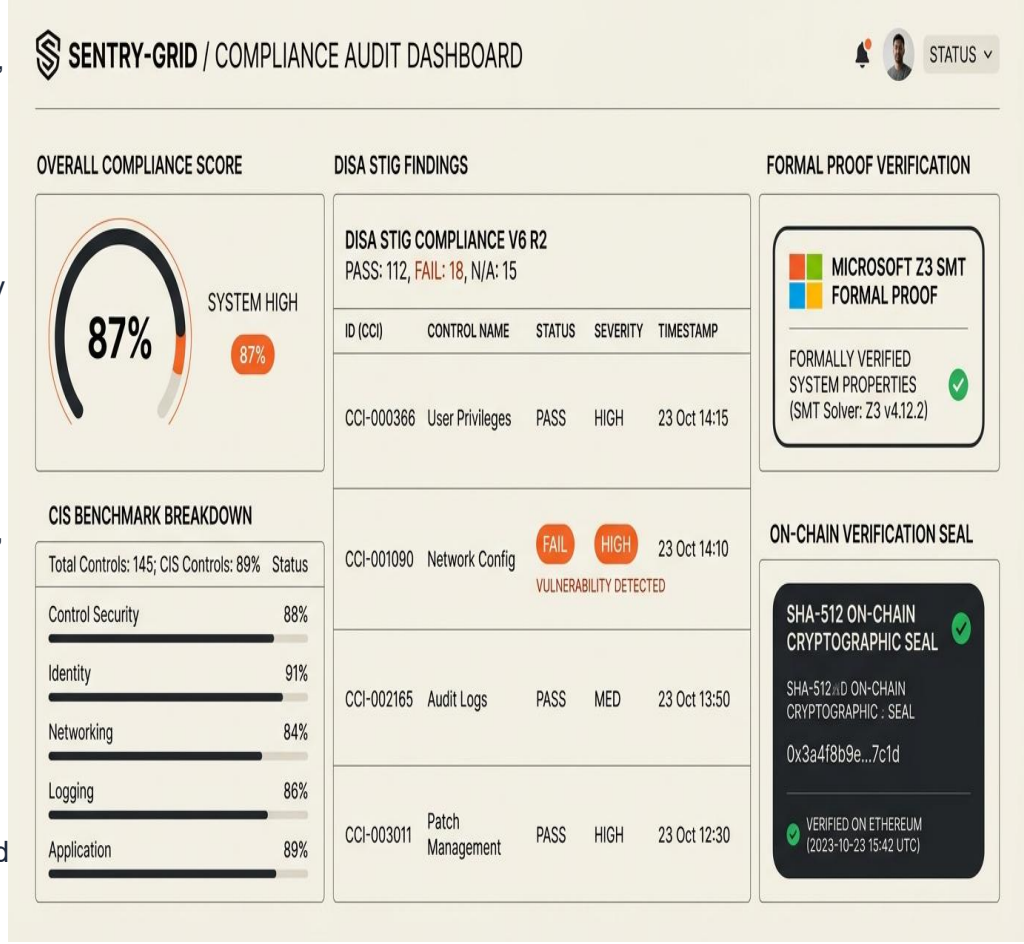
- **Technical Feasibility:** Built entirely on proven, battle-tested open-source libraries (Z3 SMT, C11, Linux, FastAPI). 100% offline and air-gappable with no cloud API dependencies. Runs on standard commodity servers (2 vCPU, 4GB RAM). [1, 7]
- **Operational Feasibility:** Completely agentless architecture using standard SSH / RESTCONF protocols. Zero daemon footprint or CPU degradation on live edge routers, firewalls, and switches. [6]
- **Financial & Commercial Viability:** Zero recurring commercial license fees. Replaces proprietary auditing tools ($50,000+/year) with a self-hosted sovereign platform, maximizing ROI for government and defense agencies.

2. Potential Challenges and Risks

- **Vendor Grammar Variations:** Inconsistent syntax, nested hierarchy, and undocumented proprietary commands across diverse vendor firmware. [6]
- **Remediation Disruption Risk:** Risk of automated remediation commands causing routing loops, network partitions, or administrative lockout.
- **AI Hallucination Risk:** AI models generating hallucinated syntax or incorrect compliance advice in air-gapped deployments. [3]

3. Strategies for Overcoming These Challenges

- **Grammar Modularity Strategy:** Declarative YAML vendor grammar specifications decouple syntax definitions from engine code, enabling rapid new vendor onboarding in hours without recompilation. [6]
- **Safe Remediation Sandbox:** Two-man rule approval gate + dry-run pre-flight check + automated transactional rollback state machine built into Ansible execution.
- **Formal Theorem Guardrails:** Z3 SMT Formal Theorem Prover acts as an unbreakable mathematical guardrail: any AI-suggested rule must be proven logically correct before presentation. [3, 4]



RESEARCH CITATIONS: [1] NIST SP 800-53 r5 | [3] Microsoft Research Z3 SMT | [4] Stanford Header Space Analysis | [6] IETF RFC 3826/4253 | [7] CERT-In CII Guidelines

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IMPACT, AUDIENCE & QUANTIFIABLE BENEFITS

SMART INDIA HACKATHON 2026

1. Potential Impact on the Target Audience

- **Target Audience:** Directly empowers NTRO, Indian Armed Forces (Tri-Services), NCIIP CERT-In, and critical enterprise infrastructure (Power Grid, Banking, Telecom). [7]
- **Audit Acceleration:** Reduces configuration compliance audit duration from 14 business manual forensic inspection down to 1.2 seconds per device.
- **Vulnerability Eradication:** Eliminates configuration drift and hidden vulnerabilities (unauthenticated SNMP, default credentials, permissive ACLs, exposed telnet) in real tir
- **National Security Impact:** Zero external telemetry leakage ensures defense network configurations never traverse untrusted networks. [7]

2. Benefits of the Solution (Social, Economic, Environmental)

- **Strategic & Defense:** Guarantees national cyber sovereignty, preventing nation-state reconnaissance, supply-chain exploits, and critical infrastructure blackouts. [7]
- **Economic Benefit:** Saves ₹15-25 Lakhs per enterprise data center per annum by elimir proprietary audit licenses and manual consulting fees.
- **Environmental / Compute:** High-efficiency C11 native compilation reduces CPU overh 85% compared to heavy Java/Python scanners, lowering data center power draw.
- **Legal & Compliance:** SHA-512 cryptographically chained ledger provides tamper-proof compliance evidence admissible under Indian IT Act Section 65B. [8]



RESEARCH CITATIONS: [2] CIS Benchmarks v4.0.0 | [5] Bernstein et al. Ed25519 Signatures | [7] CERT-In / NCIIPC Security Guidelines | [8] Indian IT Act Section 65B

RESEARCH CITATIONS: [2] CIS Benchmarks v4.0.0 | [5] Bernstein et al. Ed25519 Signatures | [7] CERT-In / NCIIPC Security Guidelines | [8] Indian IT Act Section 65B

ESEARCH WORK & REFERENCES | @Team Cyber Lakshya@

A. Industry Compliance Benchmarks & Security Mandates

[1] NIST SP 800-53 r5: National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST), 'Security and Privacy Controls for Information Systems and Organizations', NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5, 2020. DOI: 10.6028/NIST.SP.800-53r5.

[2] CIS Benchmarks: Center for Internet Security (CIS), 'CIS Cisco IOS Benchmark v4.0.0, Cisco NX-OS, and Juniper JunOS Benchmarks', CIS Security Hardening Guidelines, 2023. Link: https://www.cisecurity.org/benchmark

B. Formal Verification & Mathematical Theorem Proving

[3] Z3 SMT Solver: De Moura, L., & Bjorner, N. (Microsoft Research), 'Z3: An Efficient SMT Solver', in Proc. TACAS 2008, Springer LNCS vol. 4963, pp. 337-340, 2008. (Foundational SMT solver for formal network verification).

[4] Header Space Analysis: Kazemian, P., Varghese, G., & McKeown, N. (Stanford University), 'Header Space Analysis: Static Checking For Networks', in Proc. 9th USENIX NSDI, pp. 113-126, 2012. (Algorithmic reachability & packet classification).

C. Cryptographic Standards, RFCs & Indian Statutory Frameworks

[5] Ed25519 Cryptography: Bernstein, D. J., Duif, N., Lange, T., Schwabe, P., & Yang, B.-Y., 'High-speed high-security signatures (Ed25519)', Journal of Cryptographic Engineering, vol. 2, no. 2, pp. 77-89, 2012.

[6] IETF RFC Series: Internet Engineering Task Force (IETF): RFC 3826 (AES Cipher for SNMPv3), RFC 4253 (The SSH Transport Layer Protocol), RFC 8340 (YANG Tree Architecture Diagrams). Link: https://www.rfc-editor.org

[7] CERT-In CII Mandates: CERT-In & NCIIPC, 'Cyber Security Guidelines for Critical Information Infrastructure (CII) and Government Organisations', Indian Computer Emergency Response Team, Ministry of Electronics & IT (MeitY), Govt. of India.

[8] Indian IT Act Section 65B: Ministry of Law & Justice, Govt. of India, 'The Information Technology Act, 2000 (Section 65B: Admissibility of Electronic Records)' & 'Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023', Gazette of India.